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**BCAENLS101**

**I Semester B.C.A. Examination, December 2025/January 2026
(SEP) (2024 – 25 Batch Onwards)
ENGLISH LANGUAGE**

Time : 3 Hours

Max. Marks : 80

**SECTION – A
(Prose)**

I. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words : **(1×10=10)**

- 1) Describe any five means used by Soapy to get arrested in O. Henry's story "The Cop and the Anthem". Why did they fail ?
- 2) Analyse the concept of truth force as presented by M. K. Gandhi. How does he differentiate it from brute force ?
- 3) Comment on the theme of scientific responsibility in H. G. Wells' story "The Stolen Bacillus". How does the author use the character of the Bacteriologist to explore this idea ?
- 4) Justify the appropriateness of the title "*My Greatest Olympic Prize*" in the light of the events that transpired at the 1936 Berlin Olympics.

B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100** words **each** : **(2×5=10)**

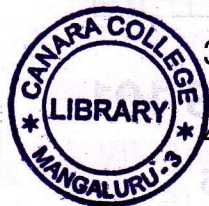
- 1) Bring out the significance of the title of O. Henry's story "The Cop and the Anthem".
- 2) Why does Gandhi believe that historical evidence of soul-force or passive resistance is often absent in conventional history ?
- 3) How is the 'pale faced man' described in H. G. Wells' story "The Stolen Bacillus" ?
- 4) How does the Aryan superiority theory or the master race theory form the background of Jesse Owens' essay "My Greatest Olympic Prize" ?
- 5) How is the dead wife described in the story "Neyipayasam" by Kamala Das ?

**SECTION – B
(Poetry)**

II. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words : **(1×10=10)**

- 1) Describe the activities that take place in the house on the night when the scorpion stings the mother in Nissim Ezekiel's poem "The Night of the Scorpion".
- 2) Comment on the problem, resolution and turning point in William Shakespeare's "Sonnet 29".

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- 3) How does Kishwar Naheed's poem "I am Not That Woman" describe the commodification of women ?
- 4) Analyze the speaker's use of irony and sarcasm in responding to the landlady's racist attitude in Wole Soyinka's poem "Telephone Conversation".
- B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100 words each** : (2×5=10)
- 1) How are the different qualities of the speaker's father and mother brought out in the poem "The Night of the Scorpion" ?
 - 2) What does the speaker envy in "Sonnet 29" ?
 - 3) Why does the speaker declare that she is not that woman selling socks and shoes in the poem "I am Not That Woman" ?
 - 4) How is the silence of the landlady described in the poem "Telephone Conversation" ?
 - 5) How is oppression portrayed in Maya Angelou's poem "Still I Rise" ?

SECTION – C
(Grammar and Composition)

Unit – 1

- III. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions set on it : (5×1=5)

The Amazon Rainforest is often called the "lungs of the Earth" as it is one of the most diverse ecosystems on our planet. Located primarily in Brazil, this vast rainforest covers around 5.5 million square kilometers and is home to millions of species of plants, animals and insects. Some species found in the Amazon are so rare that they don't exist anywhere else in the world. The rainforest plays a vital role in regulating the Earth's climate by absorbing large amounts of carbon dioxide and releasing oxygen. However, the Amazon faces serious threats. Deforestation in the Amazon, mainly due to logging, agriculture and cattle ranching, is rapidly reducing the forest's size. Each year, thousands of trees are cut down, which not only destroys the habitats of countless species but also contributes to global warming. When trees are removed, the stored carbon is released back into the atmosphere, increasing greenhouse gases and raising temperatures worldwide. Hence, conservation efforts are underway to protect this valuable ecosystem. Organizations and governments are working to create protected areas, enforce anti-logging laws and promote sustainable farming practices. Protecting the Amazon Rainforest is essential, not only for the species that call it home but for the health of the entire planet.

- a) Why is the Amazon Rainforest referred to as the "lungs of the Earth" ?
- b) What impression does the passage give about the uniqueness of the Amazon's biodiversity ?
- c) What seems to be the main threat to the Amazon Rainforest ?
- d) How does the passage describe the connection between deforestation and global warming ?
- e) What general idea does the passage give about the importance of the Amazon Rainforest for the planet ?



IV. Using the following details write a bibliography in MLA format.

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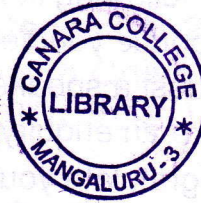
Title of the Book: Liar Among US

Publisher: Bloomsbury Publishing

Author: Bishhal Paull

Place of Publication: New Delhi

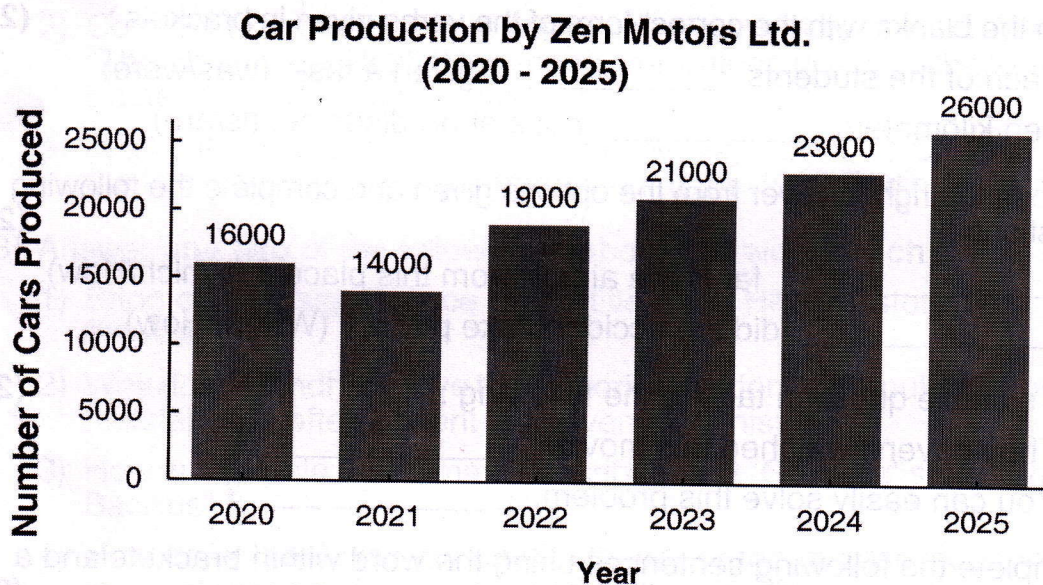
Year: 2025



V. Write a paragraph based on the information provided in the following bar diagram.

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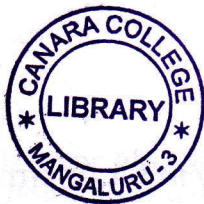
The bar diagram shows the production of cars by Zen Motors Ltd. over the past 6 years.



VI. Answer **any five** of the following in **two** sentences **each** :

(5×2=10)

- What is the difference between 'hearing' and 'listening' ?
- Distinguish between 'active listening' and 'passive listening'.
- Mention any one benefit of 'active listening'.
- What purpose does a brochure serve ?
- What does the content of a brochure convey ?
- How do advertisements influence perception ?



Unit – 2

VII. Answer **any two** of the following in **four** sentences **each** : (2×2=4)

- How would you introduce yourself to your teacher ?
- How would you request a speaker to repeat what is being said ?
- How would you make an enquiry to know about your college timings ?
- How would you congratulate your classmate who has bagged the First Prize in an Essay Competition ?

VIII. Answer **any one** of the following in **four** sentences : (1×3=3)

- Give a set of instructions on how to open a Savings Bank Account.
- Give a set of instructions on how to prepare banana juice.
- Give a set of instructions on how to operate a new laptop.

IX. Do as directed :

- Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs given in brackets : (2×1=2)
 - Each of the students _____ given a task. (was/were)
 - Ten kilometers _____ not a short distance. (is/are)
- Choose the right answer from the options given and complete the following questions : (2×1=2)
 - _____ far is the airport from this place ? (Which/How)
 - _____ did the accident take place ? (Where/How)
- Add suitable question tags to the following : (2×1=2)
 - They haven't watched this movie, _____ ?
 - You can easily solve this problem, _____ ?
- Complete the following sentences using the word within brackets and a suitable suffix from the given list : (2×1=2)
 - Never judge a person by his _____. (appear)
 - _____ is better than cure. (Prevent)
(-ion, -ness, -ment, -ance).
- Rewrite the following using an appropriate linker given within the brackets. (2×1=2)
 - Mohanti does not help anyone _____ he is extremely rich.
 - Kushal is intelligent _____ his brother is stupid.
(as, though, whereas)